

File Number: *GDU/CAO/R/Code of Conduct – Students/V1.0/2026*



Code of Conduct for Students

Effective from: *28th January 2026*

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STUDENT CODE OF CONDUCT

1) PREAMBLE

GITAM (Deemed to be University) believes that a safe, secure, and cohesive learning climate is an ineluctable precondition to quality education and research, in consensus with the preamble of the University Grants Commission. The University's primary concern is to ensure that students are protected against attacks, threats, and accidents, both man-made and natural. Hence, this code of conduct for Students is formulated to foster a safe, secure, and studious atmosphere on the university campus.

2) OBJECTIVE & APPLICABILITY

All students enrolled at GITAM are required to familiarise themselves with and adhere to this Code of Conduct and Ethics. This Code outlines the responsibilities, rights, and obligations of students and is designed to promote:

- i. A safe, inclusive, and respectful academic environment.
- ii. Holistic student development through responsible freedom.
- iii. A fair, transparent, and efficient disciplinary process.
- iv. The upholding of the university's values, mission, and reputation.

This Code applies to all full-time, part-time, on-campus, off-campus, and online students during their entire period of association with GITAM.

3) PRINCIPLES OF STUDENT CONDUCT

Students are expected to:

- i. Respect the dignity, rights, and privacy of others.
- ii. Abide by the laws of India and the rules of the University.
- iii. Maintain integrity and honesty in academic and personal conduct.
- iv. Use University resources responsibly and sustainably.
- v. Contribute positively to the campus and the broader community.

4) ACADEMIC AND EXAMINATION MISCONDUCT

All instances of academic and examination misconduct shall be addressed in accordance with the applicable Academic Regulations and Examination Regulations of the University.

5) CATEGORIES OF MISCONDUCT

Misconduct is categorised to ensure proportionality in disciplinary action. The levels reflect the **severity and impact** of the violation.

Level Classification Summary	
Level	Severity
L1 – Minor	Low-impact infractions
L2 – Moderate	Disruptive, repeated, or moderate-impact
L3 – Major	Harmful, reputationally damaging
L4 – Severe / Criminal	Serious legal, safety, or moral violations

6) PROHIBITED CONDUCT IN DETAIL

Key categories include (but are not limited to):

- i. **Ragging:** Any act of mental/physical abuse targeting new students. Strictly prohibited as per UGC Regulations.
- ii. **Substance abuse:** Use, possession, distribution of unwanted substances.
- iii. **Gender misconduct:** Sexual harassment, verbal abuse, inappropriate behaviour towards any gender.
- iv. **Violence:** Physical fights, intimidation, threats, or involvement in riots.
- v. **Cyber misconduct:** Online harassment, bullying, misinformation, impersonation, and sharing sensitive content without consent.
- vi. **Vandalism:** Damaging university or personal property.
- vii. **Illegal activities:** Criminal offences, including assault, extortion, theft, trespassing, etc.
- viii. **Unauthorised access or use** of campus premises or materials.
- ix. **Creating or circulating unverified/false information** about the University.
- x. **Unauthorised collection** of funds or trade within the campus.

7) STUDENT CONDUCT EXPECTATIONS

DO's	DON'Ts
i. Wear your ID card at all times.	i. Do not engage in acts of violence, substance abuse, or ragging.
ii. Follow campus traffic and safety regulations.	ii. Avoid disrespectful, discriminatory, or threatening behaviour.
iii. Report violations or safety concerns responsibly.	iii. Do not share sensitive photos, videos, or content without consent.
iv. Attend all academic and co-curricular activities punctually.	iv. Avoid political or communal sloganeering on campus.
v. Use the university infrastructure responsibly.	v. Refrain from spreading false information online/offline about GITAM.
vi. Participate in disciplinary hearings if summoned.	vi. Do not repeat violations or avoid previous disciplinary obligations.
vii. Follow hostel, classroom, and examination guidelines.	
viii. Maintain decorum on official tours or events.	

8) DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS & SANCTIONS

Note on escalation of penalties:

For repeated instances of the same misconduct, the penalties prescribed for the first instance (such as warning, counselling, intimation to parents, fine, restitution, and suspension) shall continue to apply, with escalation in duration or severity as specified for the second and third instances. Where a second or third instance column states that

points under the first instance will apply, all such components shall be read as incorporated by reference.

Based on the severity of the misconduct, disciplinary measures may include:

A. Residential / Hostel Misconduct

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
1	Failing to give attendance. /log in inside the hostel and report late after the permitted time	L1	RM	Warning + Intimation to Parents	Fine Rs.500 + Intimation to Parents	3 days of academic suspension
2	Unauthorised use of electrical appliances in hostel rooms	L1	RM	Warning + Intimation to Parents	Fine Rs. 500 + Intimation to Parents	3 days of academic suspension
3	Disturbing others by playing loud music	L1	RM	Warning + Intimation to Parents	Fine Rs. 500 + Intimation to Parents	3 days of academic suspension
4	Unauthorised function, meeting, gathering	L2	RDC	Warning + Fine Rs.1,000	Hostel suspension for 1 month	Hostel expulsion
5	Non-resident in a hostel room	L2	RDC	Warning + Fine Rs.1,000 (both students)	Hostel suspension for 1 month + Academic Suspension for 1 week	Hostel suspension for 1 year + Academic Suspension for 1 month
6	Indiscipline in the gym, food courts, dining areas, shops, transport, and sports areas	L1	RDC	Warning + Restitution	Fine Rs. 500 + Restitution	Hostel suspension for 1 year
7	Possession/use/ distribution of narcotic drugs/ psychotropic substances	L4	SDC	Action will be taken in line with the University's Policy on Prevention of Substance Abuse.	-	-
8	Use/Possession of e-cigarettes/Gutka	L4	SDC	Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking + 30 days	Expulsion from Hostel + Academic Suspension for 3 months	Expulsion from University

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
				academic suspension.		
9	Possession/use/distribution of unwanted substances (e.g., Alcohol, Cigarettes, Fireworks, etc.)	L3	SDC	Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking + 7 days academic suspension.	Expulsion from Hostel + Academic Suspension for 1 month	Academic suspension for 6 months
8	Damage to hostel property (minor)	L2	RDC	Fine Rs 1000 + restitution	Fine Rs. 5000 + Restitution + 7 days academic suspension	Restitution + Hostel expulsion + 1 month academic suspension
9	Damage to hostel property (major)	L3	SDC	Fine Rs.5,000 + counselling + restitution + 7 days academic suspension	Restitution + Hostel expulsion+ 1 month academic suspension	
10	Forgery of signatures / false documents / providing false info / (hostel), Misuse of Mess card, Hostel ID card	L3	SDC	Hostel Suspension 1 month	Hostel Suspension for 3 months	Hostel expulsion + Suspension for 1 year

Hostel expulsion – clarification:

Once a student is expelled from the hostel, they shall not be permitted to re-register for hostel accommodation at any time in the future. Hostel expulsion is a one-time, permanent withdrawal of hostel facilities and need not be repeated as a separate penalty in any subsequent instance of misconduct.

B. Campus Premises Misconduct

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
1	Refusing to obey institutional orders alone or with others. Shouting slogans and raising voice	L2	DoSS	Warning + Parents to come in person	Suspension for 1 month	Suspension for 3 months

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
	in a group or group complaints (includes instigating and/or participating).			and sign an undertaking		
2	Using campus facilities without approval	L2	DoSS	(i) Warning (ii) Fine Rs. 1,000	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with suspension for 1 month.	SDC referral
3	Discourtesy, disrespect, use of foul language/gestures & threatening fellow students/staff/faculty/security.	L2	DoSS	(i) Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking (ii) Fine Rs. 1,000 (iii) Counselling	Penalties under (i), (ii), and (iii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with a 1-month suspension.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension.
4	Physical abuse among students or with any faculty/staff/security	L2	DoSS	(i) Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking (ii) Restitution where applicable	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with a 1-week suspension.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension.
5	Physical abuse leading to injury among students or staff.	L4	SDC	Immediate suspension for 3 days + Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking	Suspension for 1 semester/term	Expulsion
6	Making a group with a view to take law into their own hands, arrogant behaviour and arguments with any authority and staff.	L2	DoSS	(i) Warning (ii) Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with 1 week suspension.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension.

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
7	Damage to campus property (books, buildings, gadgets, elevators, plants, fire extinguishers, vehicles)	L3	SDC	(i) Fine Rs. 1,000 (ii) Restitution (iii) Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking	Penalties under (i), (ii), and (iii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with a 1-month suspension .	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension .
8	Found in an indecent position/objectable pose with a fellow student. Public display of affection.	L2	DoSS	(i) Warning (ii) Counselling (iii) Intimation to parents	Penalties under (i), (ii), and (iii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with Fine Rs. 1,000 .	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 1-week suspension .
9	Any complaint of misconduct received from outside the campus.	L2	DoSS	Warning + enquiry + Intimation to parents	1 week Suspension	SDC referral
10	Misuse/tampering of ID cards, Bus passes, etc.	L2	DoSS / SDC	(i) Warning (ii) Fine Rs. 500	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with 1 week suspension .	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension .
11	Utilising the GITAM premises without the knowledge and consent of the concerned authorities. Exhibiting any notices or publicising any event in any form in any part of the campus without proper approval.	L1	DoSS	(i) Warning (ii) Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with Fine Rs. 500 and 1 week suspension .	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension .
12	Indiscipline in the gym, food courts, dining areas, shops, transport, and sports areas	L1	DoSS / SDC	Warning	Penalties under the 1st instance shall apply, with Fine Rs. 500 .	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
						suspension (Hostel + Academic) up to 1 month.
13	Dress code violation	L1	HoD/HoI	Warning	Penalties under the 1st instance shall apply, with Fine Rs. 500.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with suspension up to 1 month.
14	Possession/use/ distribution of narcotic drugs / psychotropic substances	L4	SDC	Action will be taken in line with the University's Policy on Prevention of Substance Abuse.	-	-
15	Use / Possession of e-cigarettes / Gutka	L4	SDC	Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking + 30 days suspension	Suspension for 3 months	Expulsion from University
16	Possession/use/ distribution of unwanted substances (e.g., Alcohol, Cigarettes, Fireworks, etc.)	L3	SDC	Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking + 7 days academic suspension.	Suspension for 1 month	Suspension for 6 months
17	Not carrying ID	L1	DoSS	Warning	Penalties under the 1st instance shall apply, with Fine Rs. 500.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with suspension for 7 days.



S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
18	Dangerous habits affecting others' safety (weapons, sharp objects, pornography, blackmail)	L4	SDC	Suspension for 1 month	Suspension for 3 months	Expulsion
19	Causing an alarm through any expression or communication to anyone physically	L2	DoSS	(i) Counselling (ii) Written apology	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with suspension for 1 month.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension.
20	Unauthorised entry to No-Go zones and Restricted areas	L2	DoSS	(i) Counselling (ii) Written apology (iii) Fine Rs. 500	Penalties under (i), (ii), and (iii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with suspension for 1 month.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with a 3-month suspension.
21	Complaint of misconduct with respect to cheating shopkeepers, students/parents, teasing girls, stalking, and/or sexually harassing the opposite gender in any way, creating nuisance in public areas, etc.	L3	SDC	Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking + 7 days academic suspension (Based on the nature of misconduct and severity, ICC may be involved)	Suspension for 1 month	Suspension for 3 months
22	Coming to Campus/Class in an inebriated condition / under the influence of alcohol and or other drugs	L4	SDC	Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking + 7 days academic suspension.	Suspension for 3 months	Expulsion

**C. Traffic & Safety Violations**

S. No	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
1	Not wearing a helmet, triple riding, tampering with a silencer, speeding, stunts, dark-tinted glass in cars/vehicles, and non-display of a vehicle pass.	L2	DoSS	Warning + Fine Rs.500	Vehicle entry suspension 1 month + Fine Rs. 1000	Vehicle entry suspension - permanent + academic suspension 1 month
2	Driving under the influence (alcohol/drugs)	L4	SDC	Suspension for 1 month	Suspension for 3 months	Expulsion

D. IT & Digital Misconduct

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
1	Unauthorised use of the GITAM name / online defaming / sharing private media	L3	SDC	(i) Warning (ii) Fine Rs. 2,000	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with suspension for 1 month.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with suspension for 1 year.
2	Cyberbullying/ harassment	L3	SDC	Immediate suspension for 3 days + Parents to come in person and sign an undertaking	Suspension for 1 semester/term	Expulsion
3	Causing an alarm through any expression or communication to anyone by electronic or social media platforms	L2	DoSS	(i) Counselling (ii) Written apology	Penalties under (i) and (ii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with suspension for 1 month.	Penalties under the 1st and 2nd instances shall apply, with suspension for 1 term.

E. Criminal / Severe Misconduct

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
1	Stealing, bribing, forgery, gambling/betting	L3	SDC	(i) Fine (ii) Suspension for 7 days (iii) Intimation to parents	Penalties under (i) and (iii) of the 1st instance shall apply, with suspension escalated to 3 months.	Expulsion
2	Group formation to challenge authority / arrogant behaviour	L3	SDC	Warning	Suspension for 3 months	Suspension for 1 year
3	Ragging (UGC / Supreme Court Guidelines)	L4	Anti-Ragging Committee + SDC	Intimation to parents + Action will be taken as per the University's Anti-Ragging Policy/UGC Anti-Ragging Guidelines.	-	-
4	Any act deemed fit for expulsion by management	L4	SDC	Immediate suspension + Intimation to parents. Expulsion if found guilty	-	-
5	Collecting money in any form or being involved in trading transactions - influencing parents/students during admissions for better branches, and confirming admission by taking money from them. Etc.	L4	SDC	Warning + Suspension for 1 month	Suspension for 3 months (or) Expulsion	-
6	Any form of informal or unauthorised financial transaction, including money lending or borrowing (such as "call	L4	SDC	Suspension for 3 months (or) Expulsion	-	-

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
	money”), charging excessive interest, pledging or exchanging jewellery, gold, valuables, or other assets, and using intimidation, harassment, or coercion for recovery or enforcement					

F. Non-Compliance / Repeat Offences

S. No.	Misconduct / Violation	Level	Handled By	1st Instance	2nd Instance	3rd Instance / Severe Offence
1	Non-compliance with SDC calls / no-show at hearings	L2	SDC	Warning + 3 days academic suspension		
2	Non-compliance / non-completion of sanctions	L4	SDC	Suspension for 1 year / Expulsion	-	-
3	Repetition of prior misconduct	L4	SDC	Suspension for 1 year / Expulsion	-	-
4	Entering campus under suspension / facing disciplinary charges	L3	DoSS	Suspension for 1 year / Expulsion	-	-
5	Interfering / false testimony / harassing participants in the disciplinary process	L3	SDC	(i) Warning (ii) Suspension for 1 month	Penalties under (i) of the 1st instance shall apply, with suspension escalated to 1 year / Expulsion.	-

NOTE:

- Counselling sessions are mandatory for all misconduct classified under L3 and L4. Certain L2 offences that require counselling have also been specifically indicated.
- In instances of serious criminal misconduct/misconduct of grave nature or intent, the University may address the case separately through the Student Disciplinary

Committee, which may impose strict disciplinary measures — including rustication, expulsion, or referral to appropriate legal authorities.

Abbreviations:

HoD	-	Head of Department
Hol	-	Head of Institution
DoSS	-	Directorate of Security & Safety
RM	-	Residence Manager
RDC	-	Residents Disciplinary Committee
SDC	-	Students' Disciplinary Committee
ICC	-	Internal Complaints Committee

9) PROCESS

Step-1: Student misconduct is reported to the Directorate of Safety & Security (DOSS)

Step-2: If the issue is deemed fit to be in Level 1 & 2, the DoSS reports to the concerned academic department and/or the Head of Campus Life, in addition to informing the parents, after which the sanctions are meted out to the student(s).

Step-3: If the issue is deemed fit to be in Level 3 and 4, the DoSS convenes a meeting of the Disciplinary Committee, after which the sanctions are meted out to the student(s).

Step-4: Mail sent to the respective HoD for information.

Step-5: Documented in Academia/ERP to keep track.

10) STUDENT RIGHTS DURING DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

GITAM ensures the disciplinary process is fair and student-centred. Every student has the right to:

- i. Be informed of the allegations in writing.
- ii. Be heard and present their side.
- iii. Receive a copy of the final decision and rationale.
- iv. Appeal the decision (within 10 working days).

11) APPEALS AND GRIEVANCES

If a student believes a decision was unjust or the process was flawed, they may file an **appeal** to the **Appellate Disciplinary Board** (headed by a senior academic official). All appeals must be submitted in writing, clearly stating the grounds for review.

Appeal Process:

Stage-1: If a student is not satisfied with the decision of the Disciplinary Committee and the sanctions imposed by it, then he/she can appeal for his/her case in writing to the Registrar, GITAM.

Stage-2: On receiving the request from the student, the Registrar, after hearing the student, may decide to refer the case once again to the disciplinary committee for reconsideration or convene the Appellate Committee.

Stage-3: The decision of the Appellate Committee is final and binding.

Note: An appeal is permitted for any misconduct at Level 3 and Level 4 only.

12) AMENDMENTS:

The University reserves the right to amend this Code of Conduct periodically to align with UGC/AICTE/NAAC guidelines and evolving best practices.

13) DECLARATION:

All students must sign a declaration acknowledging their understanding and commitment to adhere to this Code upon joining the University.

14) PREVENTION & AWARENESS

The University will:

- i. Organise regular orientation and awareness programs on student rights, responsibilities, substance abuse, anti-ragging laws, and ethical conduct.
- ii. Encourage open dialogue between students and administration.
- iii. Offer confidential counselling and support services.

15) FINAL AUTHORITY

The Vice-Chancellor and/or designated disciplinary authorities hold the final authority in interpretation, enforcement, and amendment of this Code.
